

PUBLIC SUBMISSION

As of: March 21, 2025
Received: March 14, 2025
Status: [REDACTED]
Tracking No. m89-ep9h-h445
Comments Due: March 15, 2025
Submission Type: API

Docket: NSF_FRDOC_0001

Recently Posted NSF Rules and Notices.

Comment On: NSF_FRDOC_0001-3479

Request for Information: Development of an Artificial Intelligence Action Plan

Document: NSF_FRDOC_0001-DRAFT-1544

Comment on FR Doc # 2025-02305

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General Comment

As a small business owner, I recognize the incredible potential of AI to streamline workflows, enhance creativity, and keep America at the forefront of technological innovation. However, we must ensure that AI development respects intellectual property rights, promotes fair competition, and upholds freedom of expression.

I urge this administration to take the following critical considerations into account as it shapes AI policy:

- 1. Protect Copyright & Fair Compensation:** Just as the music industry had to adapt after Napster, the publishing industry now faces a similar challenge with AI. AI models should not be allowed to ingest, monetize, or replicate copyrighted content without proper licensing and compensation. A fair and transparent licensing system for AI training data is essential to ensure that all creators—big and small—benefit from their work.
- 2. Prevent AI-Driven Censorship:** AI should not be weaponized to silence voices that platforms or corporations disagree with. The use of AI to suppress certain publishers, viewpoints, or businesses threatens the foundation of a free and open society. Algorithmic biases must be transparent and subject to public scrutiny to ensure AI upholds, rather than restricts, diverse perspectives.
- 3. Stop Big Tech from Exploiting AI to Crush Small Businesses:** Large tech companies should not be able to monopolize AI tools to eliminate competition, control distribution, or devalue independent creators. The government must ensure that AI benefits all Americans, not just corporate giants. Enforcing strong antitrust measures will prevent AI from becoming a tool for digital gatekeeping and economic consolidation.
- 4. Make the U.S. a Leader in Ethical AI Development:** We should lead in creating a balanced AI ecosystem that fosters innovation while safeguarding creativity and ownership. This means clear regulations that protect intellectual property without stifling technological growth. AI should complement human creativity, not replace or exploit it.

America is at a crossroads in AI policy. We can either protect the rights of creators, ensure fair competition, and uphold free speech—or allow unchecked AI development to strip away these freedoms. Let's choose the path that sustains innovation while respecting the value of human ingenuity.

Thank you for considering this crucial issue.